

Improving access to imported food safety requirements

Imported food safety requirements are now included in the [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#).

See more about the [Inclusion of food safety requirements in BICON](#).

All biosecurity requirements must be met before [Imported Food Inspection Scheme](#) requirements apply.

Check our [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#) for biosecurity import conditions.

Food type

Novel food is food that does not have a history of use in Australia and requires assessment by Food Standards Australia New Zealand (FSANZ) to establish its safety before being sold as a food or as an ingredient in a food.

In Australia and New Zealand, novel food and novel food ingredients are regulated under Standards 1.1.1 and 1.5.1 in [the Australia New Zealand Food Standards Code \(the Code\)](#).

If the novel food is not listed in [Schedule 25 – section 2](#) of the Code, it is not permitted for retail sale or to be used as an ingredient in a food for retail sale. An application to FSANZ to amend the Code is required.

Novel food requires a pre-market assessment by FSANZ to determine whether it poses a risk to public health. This process provides assurance on the safety of the novel food before it can be sold.

Find out more about [novel food](#) and how to submit an enquiry to FSANZ. This information includes how to:

- define what is a novel or non-traditional food
- determine whether a food is considered novel
- submit an enquiry to [FSANZ's Advisory Committee on Novel Foods \(ACNF\)](#).

Inspection and testing

We refer consignments for [inspection](#) at the rate of 5%. During inspection we will conduct a visual and label assessment under our Imported Food Inspection Scheme.

If the novel food is not listed in Schedule 25 – section 2 of the Code, imports of this food will be failed. Importers will be directed to destroy or export the food at their own expense.

See also [insects and arachnids](#) and [supplementary sports food](#) for further information on specific goods and ingredients that may be considered novel food.

Version history

Date	Amendment details
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29/07/2024	First version of the webpage published on website.
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Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/goods/food/type/novel-food>